VOL. 01 · ARTISAN SERIES

COMPLETE CULINARY EDITION



EVERYDAY KITCHEN MANUAL

SIP SMART, SPEND LESS

Four famous drinks you usually overpay for at cafes, made at home in five minutes with everyday supermarket ingredients.

4	<5	14G	8	$1.10
FULL RECIPES	MINUTES TO MAKE	REAL PROTEIN	CLEAN PAGES	AVG PER GLASS

DIFFICULTY	EQUIPMENT	BATCH SIZE	ALL 4 DRINKS
SUPER EASY	NO FANCY GEAR	1 TO 2 GLASSES	UNDER $4 TOTAL

SECTION 01 · THE REAL STORY

WHY HOMEMADE DRINKS TASTE BETTER

Most cafe drinks are overpriced for one simple reason: you are paying for the store rent and branding, not the ingredients. A $7 iced coffee contains about forty cents of coffee and milk. A $6 mango smoothie is mostly tap water ice and cheap syrup. Making these drinks at home takes five minutes, cuts your costs by 85%, and lets you use real, fresh ingredients that taste noticeably better.

$1.10	5 MIN	14G	4	0
AVERAGE COST	TOTAL TIME	CLEAN PROTEIN	WORLD CLASSICS	EXPENSIVE TOOLS

1. STOP PAYING FOR ICE AND RENT

A daily $6 takeaway drink quietly drains over $160 from your bank account every month. Making the same drink in your kitchen costs less than a single dollar for identical quality.

2. REAL FOOD BEATS SUGAR PUMPS

Chains mask stale coffee and watery bases with three squirts of artificial syrup. We use whole milk, strained Greek yogurt, and fresh spices for clean, lasting energy without sugar crashes.

3. FASTER THAN WAITING IN LINE

Driving to a cafe and standing in a morning queue takes fifteen minutes. Every drink in this book goes from your fridge to your glass in three to five minutes flat.

4. LEARN THE RATIOS, SKIP THE STRESS

You do not need to memorize complex recipes. Once you understand the core ratio of tea to milk, or yogurt to fruit, you can adjust sweetness and thickness by eye without measuring.

SIGNATURE DRINK	CAFE PRICE	KITCHEN COST	YOUR SAVINGS	REAL PROTEIN	TIME TO MAKE
Irani Chai (Hyderabad Milk Tea)	$4.50	**$0.60**	SAVE 86%	8g	5 min
Alphonso Mango Lassi	$6.00	**$0.90**	SAVE 85%	14g	3 min
Fresh Mint Mojito	$7.50	**$1.20**	SAVE 84%	1g	4 min
Vietnamese Iced Coffee	$6.50	**$1.10**	SAVE 83%	4g	5 min

The Real Savings: Making your daily drink at home saves roughly $145 every month. That is over $1,700 staying in your bank account every single year.

SAVE $1,740 / YEAR

RECIPE 01 · RICH SPICED MILK TEA

IRANI CHAI

$0.60 PER GLASS

The famous tea from the old cafes of Hyderabad. It is thick, creamy, fragrant with crushed cardamom, and so comforting you will never want a watery tea bag again.

165	8G	18G	6G	5 MIN	1 TO 2
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBS	GOOD FATS	TOTAL TIME	GLASSES



STEAMING SPICED IRANI MILK TEA

WHAT YOU NEED

- [ ] **1 cup** — Full-fat whole milk (essential for richness)
- [ ] **1 cup** — Cold water
- [ ] **1 heaped tbsp** — Strong black loose tea (Assam or CTC)
- [ ] **2 tbsp** — Sweetened condensed milk (to taste)
- [ ] **3 pods** — Green cardamom (cracked open)
- [ ] **Small pinch** — Saffron threads (optional, for aroma)
- [ ] **2 drops** — Rose water (adds subtle bakery scent)

WHY THIS METHOD WORKS

Never boil tea leaves directly in milk. Milk proteins coat the dry tea leaves and trap the flavor inside. Boiling the leaves in water first pulls out all the bold tea flavor. Adding the warm milk at the end keeps the drink silky and smooth without any bitterness.

EASY STEP BY STEP INSTRUCTIONS

01 **Boil the strong tea base.** Add the water and loose black tea leaves to a small saucepan. Bring it to a rolling boil over high heat, then turn the heat down and let it simmer for 3 minutes. The liquid will turn dark, deep, and strongly aromatic.

02 **Warm and spice the milk.** While the tea simmers, heat your whole milk in a second small pot with the cracked cardamom pods and saffron. Let it simmer gently on medium-low heat for 4 minutes so the milk thickens slightly and drinks in the spice aroma.

03 **Pour and create natural froth.** Pour the dark tea through a small fine strainer into your mug until it is half full. Now pour the hot spiced milk right over it from a few inches above the cup. The gentle drop creates a layer of creamy foam on top naturally.

04 **Sweeten and enjoy.** Stir in the sweetened condensed milk until it melts completely into the warm tea. Add two drops of rose water, stir once, and drink while it is steaming hot.

HOW TO DRINK IT: THE BISCUIT DUNK

In Hyderabad cafes, this tea is always served alongside Osmania biscuits, which are buttery and lightly salted. Dip the biscuit into the hot chai for two seconds. The salt in the biscuit cuts right through the sweet condensed milk for an unforgettable bite.

WANT IT EXTRA THICK?

Let the milk pot simmer on low heat for an extra 5 minutes, stirring occasionally with a spoon. As water slowly cooks off, the milk reduces into a rich, creamy base that coats the back of your spoon like melted ice cream.

RECIPE 02 · CREAMY PROTEIN SMOOTHIE

MANGO LASSI

$0.90 PER GLASS

A thick, frosty yogurt shake that tastes like sweet sunshine. With 14 grams of natural protein from Greek yogurt, this is satisfying enough to be breakfast or a post-workout treat.

210	14G	28G	3G	3 MIN	1 TO 2
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBS	NATURAL FATS	TOTAL TIME	GLASSES



COLD CUT ALPHONSO MANGO LASSI

WHAT YOU NEED

- [ ] **1 cup** Plain Greek yogurt (full fat gives the thickest texture)
- [ ] **1 cup** Ripe mango chunks (fresh Alphonso or frozen)
- [ ] **1/2 cup** Cold whole milk (adjust for thickness)
- [ ] **1 tbsp** Honey or raw sugar (to taste)
- [ ] **1/4 tsp** Ground cardamom (the secret to real flavor)
- [ ] **4 cubes** Ice cubes (skip if using frozen mango)
- [ ] **1 tbsp** Chopped raw pistachios (for crunchy topping)

WHY THIS METHOD WORKS

Greek yogurt is naturally strained, meaning the watery liquid has been removed. That gives you twice the protein of normal yogurt and a velvety dessert texture without needing ice cream. Sweet ripe mango provides natural sugars, so you only need a little honey.

EASY STEP BY STEP INSTRUCTIONS

01 **Put everything in the blender.** Add your Greek yogurt, mango chunks, cold milk, honey, ground cardamom, and ice cubes right into your blender pitcher.

02 **Blend until completely smooth.** Turn your blender to high speed and blend for 45 to 60 seconds. Stop as soon as the mango is fully puréed and you see a bright, glossy golden color with small bubbles on top.

03 **Taste and check thickness.** Dip a clean spoon in. If it is too thick to drink through a straw, add two tablespoons of cold milk and pulse for five seconds. If your mango was slightly tart, add a little extra honey.

04 **Pour and top.** Pour into a cold tall glass. Scatter the chopped pistachios over the surface and dust with a tiny pinch of cardamom. Drink right away while it is icy and refreshing.

BETTER THAN STORE-BOUGHT SMOOTHIES

Supermarket smoothies are pasteurized after bottling to sit on shelves for months, which kills off beneficial probiotic cultures, and they often contain over 30 grams of added sugar syrup. Blending real yogurt and fresh fruit gives you living probiotics and clean fuel.

NEED EVEN MORE PROTEIN?

Add one scoop of plain or vanilla protein powder before blending. The bold mango and sweet cardamom completely mask any chalky protein powder taste, boosting this single glass to over 30 grams of muscle-building protein.

RECIPE 03 · THE SPARKLING COOLER

FRESH MOJITO

$1.20
PER GLASS

Crisp, icy, and deeply refreshing. We press real juicy lime wedges and fresh spearmint to pull out their natural oils, topped with fizzy sparkling water over a mountain of crushed ice.

75	1G	16G	0G	4 MIN	1
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBS	FATS	TOTAL TIME	GLASS



CHILLED CRISP SPEARMINT MOJITO

WHAT YOU NEED

- [ ] **1 whole** — Fresh lime (cut into 4 chunky wedges)
- [ ] **10 to 12** — Fresh mint leaves (bright green, tender)
- [ ] **2 tbsp** — Simple sugar syrup (or raw sugar)
- [ ] **3/4 cup** — Cold sparkling water or club soda
- [ ] **1 cup** — Crushed ice (crushed chills way faster than cubes)
- [ ] **1 sprig** — Fresh mint bouquet and lime wheel for top

WHY THIS METHOD WORKS

The secret to a great mojito lives in the lime skin, not just the juice. Pressing the lime wedges against the glass squeezes aromatic oils out of the peel directly into the sugar. That produces a bright citrus scent that bottled juice can never match.

EASY STEP BY STEP INSTRUCTIONS

01 **Press the lime and syrup.** Drop your four lime wedges skin-side down into the bottom of a tall glass. Pour the simple syrup over them. Use a muddler or the handle of a wooden spoon to press down firmly 4 or 5 times to squeeze out all the juice and peel oils.

02 **Wake up the mint leaves.** Place the mint leaves flat in the palm of your hand and give them one loud clap with your other hand. This instantly releases the mint aroma without shredding the leaf. Drop the leaves into the lime juice and gently tap them once.

03 **Pack with ice and stir up.** Fill the glass three-quarters full with crushed ice. Slide a long spoon down to the bottom and gently pull upward with a twist. This lifts the lime chunks and mint leaves so they float evenly throughout your drink.

04 **Top with fizz and garnish.** Fill the glass to the top with cold sparkling water. Add a little more crushed ice on top, clap your fresh mint sprig to release its aroma, and tuck it in next to a lime wheel. Sip through a straw placed right beside the mint.

MAKE IT A COCKTAIL OR KEEP IT CLEAN

This recipe is built as an all-day refreshing mocktail. If you want a classic cocktail for a party or dinner, simply stir in 1.5 ounces (45ml) of white rum right after pressing the limes.

DO NOT GRIND THE MINT

Never twist or grind your muddler over mint leaves. Twisting tears the leaf veins and releases bitter, grassy chlorophyll that makes your drink taste like wet lawn clippings. One quick hand clap and a gentle press into the juice is all you need for pure, sweet mint flavor.

RECIPE 04 · THE SAIGON SLOW DRIP

VIETNAMESE ICED COFFEE

$1.10 PER GLASS

Cà phê sữa đá in its truest street form. Strong, buttery, dark-roast coffee dripping slowly through a stainless steel Phin filter straight over rich, sweet condensed milk.

190	4G	26G	7G	5 MIN	1
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBS	RICH DAIRY FATS	TOTAL TIME	GLASS



AUTHENTIC STAINLESS PHIN SLOW DRIP

WHAT YOU NEED

- [ ] **3 tbsp** Coarse dark roast coffee (Robusta or Cafe Du Monde)
- [ ] **2 to 3 tbsp** Sweetened condensed milk (add more if you like sweet)
- [ ] **1/2 cup** Boiling hot water (just off the boil)
- [ ] **1 full cup** Solid ice cubes
- [ ] **1 unit** Vietnamese Phin filter (cheap metal drip filter)

WHY THIS METHOD WORKS

Authentic Vietnamese coffee uses dark-roasted Robusta beans instead of mild Arabica. Robusta has almost twice the caffeine and a bold, chocolate, smoky taste with very low acidity. That bold bitterness cuts cleanly through the thick condensed milk so it never tastes sickeningly sweet.

EASY STEP BY STEP INSTRUCTIONS

01 **Start with the sweet base.** Spoon your sweetened condensed milk right into the bottom of a heatproof glass. It will settle in a thick, velvety layer at the base.

02 **Set up and bloom the coffee.** Place the metal Phin plate and cup over your glass. Add the ground coffee and shake gently to level it. Drop the small metal gravity screen on top of the grinds without pressing down hard. Pour in 2 tablespoons of hot water and wait 30 seconds for the grounds to swell and bloom.

03 **Let it drip slowly.** Fill the Phin chamber to the rim with the rest of your hot water and set the small lid on top. Watch the dark coffee drip steadily into the condensed milk below. It should take about 3 to 4 minutes to drip completely through.

04 **Stir, ice, and sip.** Take the metal filter off and set it upside down on its lid. Use a spoon to vigorously stir the hot dark coffee and condensed milk together until it turns a silky caramel color. Fill the glass with ice cubes, stir once more until frosty, and drink through a straw.

NO PHIN FILTER? USE WHAT YOU HAVE

If you do not have a metal Phin filter yet, brew a 1/3 cup of double-strength dark roast coffee using an AeroPress, French press, or moka pot. Pour it directly over the condensed milk, stir well, and dump over ice. You get 90% of the authentic street taste.

WATCH THE DRIP SPEED

If the coffee finishes dripping in under 2 minutes, your grinds are too coarse or the metal screen is too loose. If it takes longer than 5 minutes, grind a bit coarser next time. You want a steady, lazy drip that pulls out all the rich coffee oils.

SECTION 05 · THE KITCHEN TOOLKIT

HOMEMADE SYRUPS, SPICES & EASY SWAPS

Every drink in this book is built from simple building blocks you can mix and match. Once you know these quick syrup ratios and easy ingredient swaps, you can customize any drink to whatever you have in your fridge without buying single-use bottles.

1 QUICK HOMEMADE SYRUPS

Basic Simple Syrup	Equal parts sugar and boiling water (1:1), stir 1 min
Cardamom Syrup	Simple syrup + 5 crushed pods, steep 15 min
Fresh Mint Syrup	Blend 1 cup simple syrup with 1 cup mint, strain
Brown Sugar Syrup	Equal parts brown sugar + warm water, stir smooth
How to Store	Keep in any clean jar in fridge for up to a month

2 EVERYDAY SPICE BLENDS

Quick Chai Spice	Ground cardamom + cinnamon + touch of ginger
Golden Saffron Milk	Pinch of saffron steeped in 2 tbsp warm milk
Mojito Sugar Rim	Coarse sugar mixed with fresh grated lime zest
Coffee Cocoa Dust	Equal parts cocoa powder and ground cinnamon
Storage Tip	Mix a small jar on Sunday to use all week long

3 MILK & DAIRY SWAPS

No Condensed Milk?	Use coconut condensed milk or brown sugar + milk
Dairy-Free Lassi	Use plain coconut yogurt or blended silken tofu
Best Plant Milk	Barista edition oat milk gives the creamiest body
Quick Cold Foam	Shake 3 tbsp milk + 1 tsp syrup in a jar for 20 sec
Texture Note	Nut milks thin out faster on ice, so use less ice

4 FRUIT & SWEETNESS SWAPS

No Fresh Mango?	Canned Alphonso pulp costs $3 and works perfectly
Other Fruit Lassis	Swap mango for strawberries, peaches, or papaya
Natural Sweeteners	Pure maple syrup, agave, or mashed soft dates
Coffee Choices	Dark French roast gives the boldest cafe flavor
Freezer Hack	Freeze ripe fruit in pre-cut bags for fast smoothies

QUICK INGREDIENT SUBSTITUTION TABLE

WHAT RECIPE ASKS FOR	EVERYDAY BUDGET SWAP	HIGH PROTEIN SWAP	DAIRY-FREE SWAP	HOW IT CHANGES THE TASTE
Sweetened Condensed Milk	Brown sugar + splash of milk	Vanilla protein shake base	Coconut condensed milk	**Just as sweet, slight caramel or coconut hint**
Plain Greek Yogurt	Regular plain yogurt strained in towel	Icelandic skyr (18g protein)	Plain coconut yogurt	**Same thick texture, pleasant tangy finish**
Fresh Alphonso Mango	Canned mango pulp or frozen chunks	Frozen mango + Greek yogurt	Fresh mango (already vegan)	**Canned is sweeter, so use less honey**
Fresh Spearmint Leaves	Crushed peppermint leaves	A single drop of food-grade mint oil	Fresh sweet basil leaves	**Fresh herbs give the cleanest aroma**
Strong Loose Black Tea	2 English Breakfast tea bags	Strong steeped Assam tea	Rooibos tea (caffeine free)	**Bold, hearty tea taste that holds up to milk**

ARTISAN DRINK SERIES · VOLUME 01 · 2024 COMPLETE EDITION

SIP SMART, SPEND LESS

Four world-class drinks. Four simple kitchen systems. Made in under five minutes for less than $1.50 a glass, using ingredients you can find at any regular grocery store.

- **Budget Verified:** Every drink costs less than $1.50 per glass, tested with real supermarket prices.
- **Everyday Ingredients:** No weird powders or hard-to-find syrups. Everything is in standard grocery aisles.
- **Real Food, Real Energy:** Packed with fresh dairy, natural fruit, and real spices instead of corn syrup.
- **Easy Custom Swaps:** Fully modular with simple dairy-free, vegan, and low-sugar alternatives.
- **No Fancy Equipment:** Made with everyday saucepans, drinking glasses, and standard kitchen blenders.
- **Easy to Scale:** Double or triple the quantities easily to make a big party pitcher for family and friends.

01. Hyderabad Irani Chai (1 glass)	$0.60
02. Alphonso Mango Lassi (1 glass)	$0.90
03. Fresh Mint Mojito (1 glass)	$1.20
04. Vietnamese Iced Coffee (1 glass)	$1.10
TOTAL FOR ALL 4 HOMEMADE DRINKS	**$3.80**
BUYING ALL 4 AT A SPECIALTY CAFE	$24.50+

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